



SUMMER INTERNSHIP REPORT

**CRY - Child Rights and You, partnered with SAKSHAM
NGO**

Duration: 12th June – 26th July 2025

Location: Saket, Delhi

Topic: Child Development and Community-Based Child Rights Practices

Agency Guide: Ms Savita, Manager of interns at CRY

Mr, Santlal, Manager at Saksham

Submitted To:

Miss Savita Verma

Manager at CRY

Submitted By:

Khushi Usmani

M.S.W.

Aligarh Muslim University

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

First and foremost, I would like to express my heartfelt gratitude to **CRY – Child Rights and You** for providing me with the opportunity to be a part of their impactful internship program. This experience has been both enriching and enlightening, allowing me to witness and contribute to grassroots-level development work.

A special thank you goes to the **entire team at Saksham NGO** for their continuous guidance, support, and warmth throughout the fieldwork at Shahabad Dairy. Their dedication to the community and their unwavering efforts in uplifting children and women inspired me deeply.

I would also like to sincerely thank **Miss Savita Verma and Miss Smirti**, our supervisor, whose support, insights, and mentorship played a crucial role in shaping my learning during the internship. Their encouragement and trust gave me the confidence to engage meaningfully in every activity.

Lastly, I am grateful to the **community members, especially the children and women of Shahabad Dairy**, who welcomed us with openness and allowed us to learn from their lived experiences. Their resilience and strength left a lasting impact on me.

About the Organization – CRY (Child Rights and You)

CRY – Child Rights and You is a leading Indian non-governmental organization working to ensure the rights of underprivileged children. Founded in 1979 by Rippan Kapur, CRY has grown into a nationally recognized movement advocating for children's health, education, protection, and participation.

CRY's vision is “**a happy, healthy, and creative childhood for every child**”. Its mission is to enable people to take responsibility for the situation of underprivileged children and motivate them to seek resolution through individual and collective action.

CRY works through a partnership model by supporting grassroots-level NGOs like **Saksham**. Rather than running its own schools or shelters, CRY strengthens community-based organizations to create sustainable, long-term change.

Key Areas of Work:

- **Education:** Ensuring access to quality, uninterrupted education for every child.
- **Health & Nutrition:** Focusing on early childhood care, immunization, and combating malnutrition.

- **Child Protection:** Addressing issues like child labor, trafficking, abuse, and early marriage.
- **Participation:** Promoting platforms for children to express their views and take part in decisions that affect them.

CRY operates across India, with field interventions in urban slums, rural villages, and marginalized tribal regions. It works in close collaboration with families, communities, volunteers, local bodies, and government departments.

The organization also conducts research, campaigns, and policy advocacy to influence systemic change and make child rights a priority in public discourse.

Through its work, CRY has brought lasting impact to the lives of over **3 million children** and continues to strive toward a more just and inclusive society where every child has a fair chance at life.

WEEK 1

Internship Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Diary, Delhi

Week: 12th June to 18th June 2025

ORGANISATIONAL PROFILING

CRY – Child Rights and You is a non-profit organization founded in **1979** by **Rippan Kapur**, an Indian Airlines purser, along with six friends and a modest fund of Rs. 50. Over more than four decades, CRY has grown into one of India's most recognized child rights organizations.

Vision

"A happy, healthy and creative child whose rights are protected and honoured in a society that is built on respect for dignity, justice and equity for all."

Mission

- **Taking Responsibility:** To enable people to take responsibility for the situation of the deprived Indian child and motivate them to seek resolution through individual and collective action—ultimately enabling children to realise their full potential.

Why CRY Focuses on Children

Children are considered the building blocks of the nation's future. CRY believes that investing in children today will create the leaders, educators, and change-makers of tomorrow—our scientists, politicians, athletes, and artists.

Areas of Work

As shown in their key programmatic focus areas, CRY addresses critical issues affecting children's well-being:

- **Child Education**
- **Child Health & Nutrition**
- **Stop Child Labour**
- **Support Girl Child Education**
- **Stop Child Marriage**
- **Prevent Child Trafficking**
- **STEM Education**

These areas are aligned with CRY's commitment to ensuring that all children enjoy their fundamental rights without discrimination.

Scale of Impact

- Works with **102 local NGOs**
- Present across **19 states in India**
- Has impacted the lives of **over 3 million children**

Global Presence

CRY has international support operations in:

- **United States (US)**
- **United Kingdom (UK)**

This global presence helps amplify the voices of underprivileged children and garners financial and advocacy support from individuals and corporations worldwide.

Awards & Recognition

CRY's work has earned widespread recognition over the years, including:

- **ET Shark Awards (2021)** – Best Campaign in Communication
- **Best Non-Profit Campaign (Silver, 2021)** – “Don’t Help Children”
- **Best Campaign in Not-For-Profit (Silver, 2024)**
- **Most Trusted NGO (2018)**
- **Quality Initiative Mission Award (2013)**

COMMUNITY PROFILING

INTRODUCTION

1. **Name of the Community/Village:** Shahbad Dairy
2. **Block:** Rohini
3. **District:** North-West Delhi
4. **State & Country:** Delhi, India

POPULATION

1. **Population Count (Number):** Over 100,000
 - o a) **Number of Families:** Approx. 21,000
 - o b) **Gender Ratio:** Data not available (gender imbalance inferred due to social conditions)
2. **Demographic Analysis:** High-density slum-resettlement colony; population steadily growing due to migration and urban sprawl.
3. **Political Allegiance:** Active participation by AAP, BJP, and INC; politically aware residents.
4. **Religious Ratio:** Predominantly Hindu and Muslim populations; presence of both temples and mosques.

HISTORY

1. **History of the Region:** Initially a rural area, Shahbad Dairy transformed into an urban settlement due to resettlement drives.
2. **History of the Community:** Established over 25 years ago as a relocation site for displaced families from various unauthorized colonies in Delhi.
3. **History of Political Ruling:** Dominated by AAP and BJP in recent years. Political presence remains strong during civic elections.

HOUSING

1. **Type:** Mixed; majority **Pucca** houses with scattered **Kachcha** dwellings.
2. **Belongingness:** Majority are owner-occupied with some rented accommodations.
3. **Plot Size:** Typically small; congested lanes and closely packed houses.

4. **Cost/Value:** Lower-income segment housing; informal valuation due to unregulated ownership.
5. **Built Quality:** Generally poor to average; many homes lack ventilation and drainage systems.

ECONOMY

1. **Employment (%):** Estimated over 60% employed (mostly informal sector).
2. **Unemployment (%):** Approx. 30–40% due to lack of skilled opportunities.
3. **Type of Employment:** Daily wage labor, e-rickshaw drivers, rag-pickers, small vendors, domestic workers, and small eateries.

EDUCATION

1. **Schools (Number):** Several schools including government and private.
2. **Primary Schools:** 2–3 (e.g., Sarv Shiksha Abhiyan Branch)
3. **Secondary Schools:** 2 (e.g., St. Xavier's School)
4. **Further/Higher Education:** Nearby colleges include Delhi School of Professional Studies & Research.
5. **Qualifications:** Basic education common; higher education limited due to economic constraints.
6. **Attitudes Towards Education:** Mixed; growing awareness with active NGO involvement (e.g., CRY).
7. **Distance of Schools:** Most within 1–2 km range.

CRIME

1. **Statistics:** High incidence of petty thefts, substance abuse, and gender-based violence. Police station active in Sector 31.

HEALTH

1. **Health Centres (Number):** At least 3 major centers.
2. **Type:**
 - MH Shahbad Daulatpur (Govt.)
 - MCW Shahbad Daulatpur (Govt.)
 - Children & Maternity Centre (Public/NGO)
3. **Distance:** Within 0.5 to 1.5 km for most residents.

FACILITIES & RESOURCES

1. **Key Agencies:** NGOs such as CRY, Saksham, Sightsavers; informal CBOs.
2. **Community Development Team:** Mostly NGO-led initiatives.
3. **Leisure Facilities:** Limited public parks (e.g., B-Block Park, Joggers Park).
4. **Shopping:** Local markets and general stores (e.g., Patel's General Store, Sahbad Dairy Market).
5. **Worship:** Numerous temples and mosques including Kali Mata Mandir, Tayyaba Jama Masjid.
6. **Library:** No public library known; educational NGOs may provide learning spaces.

PHYSICAL ENVIRONMENT

1. **Size:** Large and densely populated settlement.
2. **Ward Boundaries:** Falls under multiple urban wards in Rohini; governance under North Delhi Municipal Corporation.

3. **Attitudes:**

- a) **Workers:** Often migratory, hard-working, seeking stable employment.
 - b) **Residents:** Resilient, community-dependent, wary of authorities.
 - c) **Non-residents:** View area as unsafe; stigmatized due to crime and poverty.
4. **Environmental Issues:** Poor drainage, garbage accumulation, air and water pollution.

11.0 TRANSPORT

1. **Personal/Private:** E-rickshaws, cycles, motorcycles common.
2. **Public Transport:** Buses frequent; nearest railway stations are Khera Kalan and Badli.
3. **Availability & Cost:** Moderate; affordable but not always reliable or safe.
4. **Type of Road:** Predominantly **Pucca**, but narrow and poorly maintained internal roads.

NEEDS ANALYSIS

- Improved sanitation and sewage management
- Women's safety and public lighting
- Skill development programs for youth
- Access to clean drinking water
- Strengthening of public healthcare infrastructure

ABOUT THE SAKSHAM NGO

Saksham NGO

Project Office: Shahbad Dairy, Prahladpur, Delhi – 42

Area Office: Rohini Sector-5, Bhagwan Mahavir Road, Delhi – 85

Email: saksham.del1@gmail.com

Operational Areas:

Saksham works in several localities including:

- Shahbad Dairy
 - Prahladpur Bangar
 - Prem Nagar
 - Swaroop Nagar
 - Sultanpuri
 - Mangolpuri
 - Budh Vihar
 - Vijay Vihar
 - Kirari Suleman Nagar
 - Rohini Sector 28 & 5
-

Core Activities and Programs:

1. CAC (Child Activity Center) Operations

- Locations: Shahbad Dairy, Sultanpuri, Swaroop Nagar
- Timings:
 - Morning: 9:00 AM to 11:30 AM
 - Afternoon: 2:30 PM to 5:00 PM

2. CAC Digital Classes for Children

- Days: Monday to Friday
- Timing: Same as CAC hours

3. CAC Life Skill Sessions for Children

- Conducted weekly within CAC schedule

4. DLC (Digital Learning Center)

- Areas: Swaroop Nagar and Prem Nagar
- Timing: 2:30 PM to 5:00 PM

5. Cricket Practice (With Umeed Foundation)

- Location: Swaroop Nagar
- Days: Monday, Tuesday
- Time: 2:30 PM to 5:00 PM

6. Digital Literacy Program

- Duration: 3–5 days or up to 2 weeks
- For local adolescents and children

7. Women Empowerment Program – Shahbad Dairy

- Focused on:
 - Women's health and hygiene
 - Menstrual awareness
 - Safety awareness
 - Legal rights and leadership building
- Location: A-1 Gupta Colony, Bengali Gali, Prahladpur Bangar

8. Self-Defense Training

- Weekly sessions on Saturdays and Sundays
- Timing: 3:00 PM to 5:00 PM

Other Activities:

Legal Literacy and Awareness

- Topics: Police procedure, FIR filing, child rights, juvenile justice
- Conducted with experts and legal professionals

Career Counseling & Vocational Training

- Support based on need and situation
 - Includes motivational sessions, goal setting, and parent engagement
-

Regular Events and Campaigns:

- **Cultural Events:** Annual Day, Diwali, Independence Day, Children's Day
- **Awareness Campaigns:** Education, child protection, health, environment, menstrual health
- **Sports Activities:** Competitions and training
- **Creative Engagement:** Drawing, slogan writing, essay competitions, digital art

WEEK 2

CONDUCTED CASE STORIES OF SAKSHAM CRICKET TEAM

Internship Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Diary, Delhi

Week: 19th June to 25th June 2025

During Week 2, the trainees engaged in the detailed documentation of case stories of 16 students who are active participants in the Saksham Cricket Team. The primary goal was to understand the background, challenges, and transformations experienced by these children through their involvement in cricket, and to highlight the role of CRY and Saksham in shaping these journeys.

Methodology:

- **Interviews and Conversations** with the children were conducted.
- **Themes Explored:** Family background, socio-economic vulnerabilities, initial challenges in accessing cricket, support systems, current participation, and personal development.

Key Insights from the Case Stories:

1. Socio-Economic Background:

- Most children come from **low-income households** where parents work as daily wage laborers, domestic workers, or in informal jobs.
- Several children live in **single-parent households**, or large families with multiple siblings, resulting in **financial stress** and limited individual attention.
- Domestic responsibilities—especially for girls—often compete with their time for sports and study.

2. Barriers to Participation:

The children faced various challenges in joining or continuing with cricket:

- **Financial Constraints:** Inability to afford gear, kits, shoes, or travel expenses.
- **Lack of Equipment:** Many relied on borrowed bats and gloves or shared gear.
- **Parental Resistance:** Concerns over safety, distraction from academics, or cultural hesitance toward girls in sports were common.
- **Household Responsibilities:** Chores, caregiving, and tuition classes often clashed with training schedules.

3. Interventions and Support Systems:

- **Saksham and CRY's Role:** Provided cricket kits, regular coaching, structured practice schedules, and emotional encouragement.
- **Peer Encouragement:** Older players mentored juniors, fostering confidence and camaraderie.
- **Parental Engagement:** Coaches and volunteers counseled hesitant parents, gradually building trust.
- **Alternative Pathways:** In cases like Aman and Chanchal, cricket served as a second chance—offering purpose and identity when academic options were limited.

4. Impact and Transformation:

Cricket emerged as more than a sport—it became a platform for **self-expression, resilience, and leadership**. Key areas of positive change included:

- **Increased Self-Confidence:** Many students reported feeling more respected and seen in their communities.
- **Discipline and Time Management:** Children, especially girls like Shivani and Itisha, learned to balance academics, household work, and training through structured routines.
- **Academic Focus:** Students like Aarushi, Chetna, and Varun reflected improved study habits, often attributing this to the discipline learned from cricket.
- **Social Skills and Empowerment:** Boys and girls both expressed how their interactions in mixed training groups fostered respect, teamwork, and emotional growth.
- **Aspirations:** Many now dream of professional cricket careers, while others see themselves as future coaches, umpires, or leaders.

Selected Highlights:

- **Nikki**, team captain, overcame financial and parental hurdles to become a role model and mentor for younger girls.
- **Mansi**, despite emotional neglect from her family, found meaning in coaching and earning through cricket.
- **Shivam** and **Aman**, both from difficult academic journeys, used cricket to regain confidence and redefine their self-worth.
- **Payal** and **Chetna** shared powerful accounts of defying gender norms and societal expectations through their consistent presence on the field.

GROUND VISIT AND MATCH OBSERVATION

The trainees also conducted a field visit to the local ground where the Saksham team practices and plays matches. A friendly match was observed, and detailed notes were taken on the players' interactions and performance.

Key Observations Included:

Training Structure:

Coaches were seen following a structured training routine, including warm-up exercises, drills, and practice matches. Their approach encouraged participation, discipline, and teamwork.

Player Engagement:

The children displayed high energy levels, strong coordination, and mutual encouragement. Their enthusiasm and sportsmanship reflected the effectiveness of the program.

Social Impact of Sports:

The visit provided deeper insight into how sports serve as a powerful tool for social and personal empowerment at the grassroots level. The inclusive and disciplined environment fostered by the program played a vital role in shaping the children's growth.

Reflection:

This week provided the trainees with valuable experiences in understanding how structured sports initiatives like Saksham can positively influence underprivileged children. By collecting case stories

and observing the program in action, a clearer picture emerged of how sports can be leveraged to promote development, resilience, and confidence among youth.

SNAPSHOTS OF WEEK 2



WEEK 3

VISIT FOR “DELHI SARVAJANIK SHAUCHALYA SURVEY- 2025”

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

Week: 26th June – 2nd July 2025

As part of the *Delhi Sarvajanik Shauchalya Survey – 2025*, the trainees conducted a systematic assessment of public and private toilet facilities located in Blocks A, B, and E of the Shahabad Dairy area. These blocks fall under the supervision of Saksham NGO, which facilitated access and coordination for the fieldwork.

As part of the *Delhi Sarvajanik Shauchalya Survey – 2025*, the trainees carried out a structured and observational assessment of public and private toilet facilities across Blocks A, B, and E of Shahabad Dairy. These areas fall under the jurisdiction of Saksham NGO, which guided the trainees throughout the field activity.

The process was conducted in the following steps:

1. Orientation and Familiarization:

The trainees were introduced to the objectives and scope of the survey. They were briefed on the official format provided for the *Shauchalya Survey*, which served as the central framework for data collection. The format included specific indicators such as:

- Number of seats for male and female users
- Water availability
- Electricity connection
- Functional condition of doors and locks

- Presence of CCTV and complaint redressal information
 - Availability of dustbins
 - Drainage condition and general maintenance
- These indicators were crucial for ensuring standardization and comparability across different sites.

2. Field Visit and On-Site Observation:

The trainees physically visited multiple toilet units—both government-run and privately managed—located within the selected blocks. Observations were made in real-time during peak usage hours to ensure accurate assessment of user experience and facility conditions.

3. Focused Observational Parameters:

In addition to the standard survey format, the trainees also paid close attention to key human-centric and gender-sensitive factors, including:

- Adequacy and reliability of lighting, especially in women's sections
- Privacy and safety conditions, including functioning latches and enclosed spaces
- Cleanliness and hygiene levels in and around the washrooms
- Availability of soap and sanitary pads
- Presence of foul odor, stagnant water, or pest infestation

4. User Feedback Collection:

To enrich the findings, the trainees conducted informal interviews and conversations with users, including men, women, and children, to understand satisfaction levels, concerns, and suggestions for improvement. This qualitative input added depth to the numerical data collected via the form.

5. Data Recording and Compilation:

Each toilet unit was assessed individually. Information was recorded as per the survey sheet and supplemented with observational notes and user quotes. Data was then compiled block-wise for comparative analysis of private versus government-managed facilities.

By combining standardized form-based data collection with ground-level observation and community interaction, the trainees ensured a comprehensive and user-oriented understanding of the sanitation conditions in Shahabad Dairy.

Transect Walk – Shahabad Dairy (Block A), New Delhi

As part of our on-ground learning experience during the internship, the trainees participated in a transect walk through the inner lanes of Block A, Shahabad Dairy, New Delhi. This activity was facilitated by our resource persons Ayesha, a local field leader and team member from Saksham NGO.

The purpose of the walk was to engage directly with the community environment, observe the infrastructure and living conditions, and understand the spatial and social challenges faced by residents on a daily basis. Rather than being a conventional data collection exercise, the walk served as a powerful learning tool to connect policy with lived experience.

Key Observations from the Walk:

- **Extremely Narrow Lanes:**
The streets were tightly packed, making mobility difficult, especially for emergency services and sanitation vehicles.
- **Inadequate Street Lighting:**
Many areas lacked sufficient lighting, raising concerns about safety, particularly for women and children during the evening hours.
- **Lack of Public Spaces:**
There was no common community area for recreation, gatherings, or children's play, contributing to a lack of safe, shared environments.
- **Problematic Water Infrastructure:**
Water supply pipes were observed to run alongside open drains (nala), raising serious concerns about contamination and health risks.
- **Overcrowded Living Conditions:**
Homes were small and congested, with multiple family members often sharing a single room. Ventilation and privacy were severely limited.
- **Water Dependency and School Absenteeism:**
A government-provided water tank was seen as the main water source for many families. Trainees learned that children often miss school to queue for water collection, affecting their education.
- **Poor Water Quality:**
The water from the tank was reportedly smelly and yellow, raising concerns over potability and sanitation.
- **Education Deprivation:**
A notable number of children were observed roaming the streets

during school hours, indicating both low school attendance and limited parental or systemic support for education.

Reflection and Learning:

This walk was more than an observational task—it was an eye-opening experience. It brought to light the urgent need for community-focused development, where basic rights like water, sanitation, safety, and education are still inaccessible for many.

We are especially grateful for the insights shared by Anjali and Pratik, community members who narrated the day-to-day struggles and invisible burdens that residents, especially children and women, carry.

This experience reaffirmed that policies must be rooted in ground realities, and community voices must be central to any developmental planning. It strengthened our resolve as trainees to work toward a vision of inclusive, sustainable, and just urban development.

SNAPSHOTS OF WEEK 3



WEEK 4

Community Outreach for CAC Admissions

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

Week: 3rd July – 9th July 2025

During Week 4, the trainees, along with students of the Child Activity Center (CAC) and under the guidance of Miss Ayesha, conducted a community outreach initiative in the Shahabad Dairy locality. The objective of this activity was to identify eligible children aged 9 to 18 years and encourage their enrollment in Saksham's Child Activity Center.

Process Followed:

Door-to-Door Visits:

The team visited multiple households in the locality, interacting directly with parents and guardians to gather information about children who were either out of school, irregular in attendance, or lacked access to academic support.

Awareness and Counseling:

The trainees explained the purpose and benefits of the CAC (Child Activity Center). They emphasized that the program is completely free

of cost, and is designed to bridge educational gaps and enhance learning opportunities for underprivileged children.

Key Features Highlighted:

- Free education support for school-going children
- English language classes to build communication skills
- Access to a Digital Learning Center, where children are introduced to basic computer literacy, typing skills, and safe internet use
- A safe and structured learning environment to encourage consistent engagement and reduce drop-out risk

Community Response:

Parents expressed appreciation for the initiative, particularly those who were unable to afford tuition fees or lacked the time to assist their children with schoolwork.

Some families were unaware of the CAC's services, and the outreach helped create new awareness about the opportunities available through Saksham NGO.

In several cases, the trainees had to address concerns about safety, timing, and curriculum, and offered reassurance through examples of successful students currently attending CAC.

SNAPSHOTS OF WEEK 4



WEEK 5

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

Week: 10th July – 16th July 2025

Interaction with Mahila Group Members

During Week 5, the trainees had the opportunity to meet and engage in a group discussion with the Mahila Group—a network of women from Shahabad Dairy who are actively connected with Saksham NGO. These women serve as community monitors and first responders in cases involving domestic violence, female foeticide, and missing children.

Understanding the Role of the Mahila Group:

The Mahila Group members play a vital role in ensuring local accountability and early intervention within the community. They are not formally employed staff, but empowered local women trained and supported by Saksham to act as vigilant citizens and advocates for women and child protection.

They shared with the trainees that:

Many women from the locality approach them directly to report abuse, often because they feel safer confiding in someone from within the community rather than going to the police or outside agencies.

Upon receiving a complaint—particularly of domestic violence—members personally visit the household to check on the condition of the woman or child involved.

They look for signs of ongoing abuse, such as emotional withdrawal, physical injuries, or fear, and intervene when necessary, sometimes by facilitating counseling or referring the case to the NGO for legal or institutional support.

Key Insights from the Interaction:

The group revealed that cases of domestic violence are on the rise, with many incidents going unreported due to stigma, fear of retaliation, or financial dependence on the abuser.

They emphasized that their continued presence in the community builds trust, which is why many women confide in them before approaching external help.

In cases involving missing children, the group helps alert local authorities and spread word through community networks.

Female foeticide—while less visible—remains a concern in some areas, especially when families react negatively to news of a girl child.

Visit to Saksham Anganwadi Poshadh – Block F, Shahabad Dairy

The trainees visited the Saksham Anganwadi Poshadh Kendra located in Block F of Shahabad Dairy. This Anganwadi center operates under the “Mahila evam Baal Vikas Vibhag” (Department of Women and Child Development) and is supported by Saksham NGO.

The session was guided by Reshma, the designated resource person at the center, who provided the trainees with an overview of the center's functions, beneficiaries, and its role in supporting early childhood development and maternal health in the community.

Key Areas of Learning from the Visit:

1. Services and Facilities Provided:

Reshma explained that the Anganwadi provides a range of essential services to women and children, including:

- Supplementary nutrition for pregnant and lactating women, as well as for children under 6 years of age.
- Early childhood care and pre-school education, focusing on foundational literacy, hygiene habits, and cognitive development through songs, storytelling, and basic learning tools.
- Immunization support in collaboration with local health workers (ASHA/ANM).
- Health check-ups and referrals for mothers and children.
- Awareness programs on topics such as nutrition, child rights, hygiene, and gender equality.

2. Nutrition and "Poshadh" Distribution:

The center regularly distributes nutritional food packets (Poshadh) which include items such as dry ration, ready-to-eat meals, and iron/calcium supplements for women and children. Reshma emphasized that this support is crucial for families facing food insecurity and malnourishment concerns.

3. Community Engagement and Challenges:

The Anganwadi staff often conduct home visits to identify new beneficiaries, especially in underserved pockets of the locality. However, challenges such as irregular attendance, misinformation, and lack of awareness among some parents remain ongoing issues. She also mentioned how Saksham supports the Anganwadi through volunteer assistance, outreach drives, and ensuring that mothers receive correct information about available schemes and services.



SNAPSHOTS OF WEEK 5

WEEK 6

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

Week: 17th July – 23rd July 2025

Interaction with Slum Children – Informal Engagement and Trust-Building

During Week 6, the trainees conducted **informal engagement with children living in the slum settlements** of Shahabad Dairy. The aim was not just observation, but to **build rapport**, better understand the children's mindset, and **encourage them toward education**.

Highlights of the Interaction:

- Many children were seen playing or wandering unsupervised during school hours. A significant number of them had **either dropped out of school or never enrolled**.
- When asked why they weren't attending school, common responses included:
 - “I have to help at home.”
 - “I don't like school; I can't understand what they teach.”
 - “We don't have books or uniforms.”
- The trainees also spoke with a few children who had **siblings attending tuition or CAC**, which became an entry point for conversation.

- Children were encouraged to **visit the CAC center**, where they could learn in a **fun, pressure-free environment**. A few expressed interest and agreed to visit.

Reflection:

This experience emphasized the importance of **relationship-building** and **patience** in community engagement. These children are not just victims of poverty, but also of **disinterest, neglect, or cultural barriers** toward education. The interaction reinforced the belief that change begins with **consistent presence, empathy, and trust**—not just formal intervention.

Teaching and Assisting at the Child Activity Center (CAC)

In Week 6, the trainees also took an **active teaching role at the CAC center**, supporting academic and non-academic learning sessions for children aged 9–18.

Nature of Involvement:

- Trainees helped facilitate **basic academic sessions**, including **Hindi, English, and Mathematics**.
- **One-on-one support** was provided to children struggling with reading and writing, especially those who had dropped out and were re-entering learning after long gaps.
- The trainees also organized **interactive learning activities**, including:
 - Spelling games and storytelling in English
 - Basic counting and mental math sessions

- Drawing and general knowledge quizzes to enhance participation

Reflection:

Teaching at CAC was a hands-on experience in **alternative education delivery**. It made trainees aware of the **gaps in formal schooling**, especially for marginalized children, and the **importance of flexible, student-centered approaches**. It also instilled a deeper respect for the work of grassroots educators who **sustain motivation in children despite difficult circumstances**.

SNAPSHOTS OF WEEK 6



LEARNING OUTCOMES

Over the course of six weeks at **CRY – Child Rights and You**, in partnership with **Saksham NGO**, the internship offered an invaluable blend of field exposure, organizational understanding, and community engagement. The key learning outcomes are summarized below:

1. Practical Understanding of Child Rights

Trainees developed a deep insight into **ground-level implementation** of child protection, education, health, and participation rights. The real-world challenges faced by children in urban slums provided a practical context to the academic knowledge of child rights frameworks.

2. Community Engagement and Outreach Skills

Through door-to-door visits, slum interactions, and admissions drives, trainees learned how to **communicate effectively with vulnerable populations**, gain trust, and adapt their language and approach according to age, literacy level, and social background.

3. Exposure to Gender and Social Justice Issues

Engagements with **Mahila Group members** and the observation of **domestic violence, female foeticide, and educational neglect** shed light on the **intersection of gender, poverty, and marginalization**. The trainees learned the importance of local women's leadership in social change.

4. Educational Support and Teaching

Teaching at the **Child Activity Center (CAC)** helped trainees understand **alternative learning methods** for children with academic gaps. It improved their skills in **lesson planning, individual attention, and creative pedagogy**.

5. Survey and Field Research Competence

Participation in the **Delhi Sarvajanic Shauchalya Survey** and **transect walk** trained the trainees in **data collection, observation, and field analysis**, especially in sanitation, infrastructure, and public health contexts.

6. Critical Thinking and Reflection

Each interaction—whether with a child, a parent, or a community worker—invited trainees to think critically about **policy gaps, systemic limitations**, and the **importance of grassroots-led development**.

CONCLUSION

The internship with CRY and Saksham NGO at Shahabad Dairy was a transformative learning experience, blending theory with field reality. From observing sanitation systems to documenting the dreams of slum children, each week presented a new lens to view inequality, resilience, and the importance of community-based solutions.

Trainees witnessed firsthand how non-governmental organizations serve as bridges between policy and people, especially in under-resourced urban spaces. The exposure to diverse programs—such as the Cricket Team empowerment stories, CAC education model, digital learning, women's groups, and anganwadi centers—allowed for a comprehensive understanding of how multi-dimensional development work happens.

One of the most powerful takeaways was the role of trust, presence, and consistency in creating meaningful change. Whether it was a child hesitant to join a class, a mother sharing her trauma, or a volunteer leading a sports session, every moment demonstrated that social change begins with dignity, dialogue, and local leadership.

This internship has not only enriched the trainees' understanding of child rights and development work but has also deepened their empathy, sharpened their field instincts, and strengthened their commitment to working toward a just and inclusive society.

